

French A1 — Week 2 Vocabulary Reference

Crescere | Beginner French | Week 2

Sessions 3 and 4 — Avoir, Physical Description, and Personality

Items marked **Core** should be secure before Week 3. Items marked **Reference** are for recognition and independent study.

Avoir — Present Tense (Core)

French	English	Note
j'ai	I have	—
tu as	you have	—
il / elle a	he / she has	—
nous avons	we have	—
vous avez	you have (formal / plural)	—
ils / elles ont	they have	—

Key use this week: *avoir* for age — *J'ai trente ans.* (I am thirty years old.) Note: French uses "have years," not "be years."

Physical Description — Hair (Core)

French	English	Pronunciation note
les cheveux	hair (always plural in French)	lay shuh-VUH
les cheveux longs	long hair	—
les cheveux courts	short hair	—
les cheveux mi-longs	medium-length hair	—
les cheveux noirs	black hair	NWAR
les cheveux bruns	brown/dark hair	BRUN
les cheveux châains	chestnut/light brown hair	sha-TAN
les cheveux roux	red/auburn hair	ROO
les cheveux blonds	blond hair	BLON
les cheveux blancs	white/grey hair	BLON
les cheveux gris	grey hair	GREE

les cheveux lisses	straight hair	LEESE
les cheveux frisés	curly hair	free-ZAY
les cheveux ondulés	wavy hair	on-doo-LAY

Note: *cheveux* is always plural. *Elle a les cheveux longs*. Not *elle a le cheveu long*.

Physical Description — Eyes (Core)

French	English	Note
les yeux	eyes (always plural)	lay ZYUH
les yeux bleus	blue eyes	—
les yeux verts	green eyes	—
les yeux noisette	hazel eyes	invariable — no agreement
les yeux marron	brown eyes	invariable — no agreement
les yeux noirs	dark/black eyes	—
les yeux gris	grey eyes	—

Note: *marron* and *noisette* never change form: *les yeux marron*, not *les yeux marrons*.

Physical Description — Height and Build (Core)

French	English	Feminine form
grand / grande	tall	grande
petit / petite	short	petite
de taille moyenne	average height	— (no agreement needed)
mince	slim	mince (same)
costaud / costaute	sturdy, stocky	costaute

Colors as Adjectives (Core)

Most colors agree in gender and number. Exceptions noted.

French	English	Feminine	Plural (m)	Invariable?
blanc	white	blanche	blancs	No
noir	black	noire	noirs	No
gris	grey	grise	gris	No

bleu	blue	bleue	bleus	No
vert	green	verte	verts	No
rouge	red	rouge	rouges	No
jaune	yellow	jaune	jaunes	No
rose	pink	rose	roses	No
violet	purple	violette	violets	No
marron	brown	marron	marron	Yes
orange	orange	orange	orange	Yes

Rule: Invariable colors (*marron*, *orange*) never add -e or -s. All others follow the regular pattern.

Personality Adjectives (Core: 8 key ones)

French	English	Masculine	Feminine	Note
sympa	nice, friendly	sympa	sympa	Informal — invariable
drôle	funny	drôle	drôle	Same for m/f
sérieux	serious	sérieux	sérieuse	-x → -se pattern
timide	shy	timide	timide	Same for m/f
bavard	chatty, talkative	bavard	bavarde	Regular
gentil	kind	gentil	gentille	Doubles final l
patient	patient	patient	patiente	Regular
impatient	impatient	impatient	impatiente	Regular

Personality Adjectives (Reference: additional set)

French	English	Masculine	Feminine
travailleur	hardworking	travailleur	travailleuse
paresseux	lazy	paresseux	paresseuse
intelligent	intelligent	intelligent	intelligente
créatif	creative	créatif	créative
sportif	sporty	sportif	sportive
calme	calm	calme	calme
nerveux	nervous	nerveux	nerveuse

optimiste	optimistic	optimiste	optimiste
pessimiste	pessimistic	pessimiste	pessimiste
curieux	curious	curieux	curieuse

Useful Description Phrases (Core)

French	English
Il / Elle est...	He / She is...
Il / Elle a...	He / She has...
J'ai les cheveux...	I have ... hair
J'ai les yeux...	I have ... eyes
Il / Elle a les cheveux...	He / She has ... hair
Je suis... (+ adjective)	I am...
Il / Elle est de taille moyenne.	He / She is of average height.
Il / Elle a l'air...	He / She looks / seems...
À mon avis, il / elle est...	In my opinion, he / she is...

Adjective Agreement Summary (Core)

	Masculine	Feminine	Note
Regular	grand	grande	add -e
Already ends in -e	drôle	drôle	no change
-eux → -euse	nerveux	nerveuse	pattern change
-if → -ive	sportif	sportive	pattern change
-el → -elle	naturel	naturelle	double l
-il → -ille	gentil	gentille	double l
Invariable	sympa, marron, orange	—	never changes

Plural: Add -s to masculine or feminine form. If the word already ends in -s or -x, no change. *Il est nerveux* → *Ils sont nerveux*.